

Windows ↔ Ubuntu Installation & Dual Boot Guide

Overview

This document explains how to:

- Install Ubuntu on a Windows PC
 - Install Windows after Ubuntu
 - Switch between Ubuntu and Windows
 - Access the Windows setup when installation is blocked
 - Boot from a USB drive
 - Use BIOS/Boot Menu shortcuts
 - Common keyboard shortcuts used during installation
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Requirements

Hardware

- Laptop/Desktop
- Minimum 8 GB USB Flash Drive
- Stable Internet Connection
- Power Adapter (Recommended)

Software

- Windows ISO
 - Ubuntu ISO
 - Rufus (for creating bootable USB)
 - Balena Etcher (Optional)
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Creating a Bootable USB

Windows

1. Download the Windows ISO from Microsoft.
 2. Open Rufus.
 3. Insert the USB drive.
 4. Select the ISO file.
 5. Click **Start**.
 6. Wait until the process finishes.
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Ubuntu

1. Download the Ubuntu ISO.
 2. Open Rufus or Balena Etcher.
 3. Select the Ubuntu ISO.
 4. Choose the USB drive.
 5. Create the bootable USB.
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Entering BIOS / Boot Menu

Restart the computer and immediately press the boot key repeatedly.

Brand	Boot Menu	BIOS
HP	F9	F10
Dell	F12	F2
Lenovo	F12	F1 / F2
Acer	F12	F2
ASUS	Esc	F2
MSI	F11	Delete

HP Example

Press **F9** to open the Boot Menu.

Press **F10** to enter BIOS settings.

Installing Ubuntu

1. Insert the Ubuntu bootable USB.
2. Restart the PC.
3. Open the Boot Menu.
4. Select the USB drive.
5. Click **Install Ubuntu**.
6. Select your language.
7. Choose your keyboard layout.
8. Connect to Wi-Fi (optional).
9. Choose installation type:
 - Install alongside Windows
 - Erase disk
 - Manual partitioning
10. Select your timezone.
11. Create:
 - Username
 - Password
12. Click **Install**.
13. Restart the computer.
14. Remove the USB drive.

Ubuntu installation is complete.

Installing Windows

Normal Installation

1. Insert the Windows bootable USB.
2. Restart the PC.
3. Open the Boot Menu.
4. Select the USB drive.
5. Click **Install Now**.
6. Enter the product key or click **I don't have a product key**.

7. Select the Windows edition.
 8. Accept the license agreement.
 9. Choose **Custom Installation**.
 10. Select the partition.
 11. Click **Next**.
 12. Wait until installation finishes.
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If Windows Installation is Blocked

During the Windows setup screen:

Press

Shift + F10

Command Prompt opens.

Run:

start ms-cxh:localonly

This opens the local account setup and allows you to continue Windows installation without creating or signing in with a Microsoft account.

Important Note

For Windows installation you need:

- A bootable USB flash drive
- A valid Windows Product Key (if activation is required)

Without booting from the USB drive, Windows installation cannot begin.

Ubuntu to Windows

1. Create a Windows bootable USB.
 2. Boot using the USB.
 3. Delete Ubuntu partitions (if replacing Ubuntu completely).
 4. Install Windows.
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Windows to Ubuntu

1. Create free disk space in Windows.
2. Boot from the Ubuntu USB.
3. Select **Install Ubuntu alongside Windows**.
4. Complete the installation.
5. Restart the computer.

Ubuntu automatically installs **GRUB**, allowing you to choose between Windows and Ubuntu during startup.

Switching Between Windows and Ubuntu

When the PC starts, the GRUB menu appears.

Select:

- Ubuntu
- Windows Boot Manager

Use the arrow keys and press **Enter**.

Useful Boot Shortcuts

Shortcut	Function
F2	BIOS (many systems)
F9	HP Boot Menu
F10	HP BIOS Setup
F11	MSI Boot Menu
F12	Dell/Lenovo Boot Menu
Esc	ASUS Boot Menu
Delete	BIOS (MSI/Gigabyte)

Windows Installation Shortcuts

Shortcut	Purpose
Shift + F10	Open Command Prompt
Alt + Tab	Switch windows
Ctrl + Shift + Esc	Task Manager (after installation)
Win + R	Run dialog
Win + X	Quick Access Menu
Win + E	File Explorer

Ubuntu Terminal Shortcuts

Shortcut	Purpose
Ctrl + Alt + T	Open Terminal
Ctrl + C	Stop running command
Ctrl + L	Clear Terminal
Up Arrow	Previous command
Tab	Auto-complete

Monitor & Display Shortcuts (Windows)

Shortcut	Function
Win + P	Change display mode
Win + Ctrl + Shift + B	Restart graphics driver
Win + D	Show Desktop
Win + ↑	Maximize window
Win + ↓	Minimize window
Win + ← / →	Snap window
Win + +	Magnifier Zoom In
Win + -	Magnifier Zoom Out

Common Troubleshooting

USB Not Detected

- Recreate the bootable USB.
 - Try another USB port.
 - Enable USB Boot in BIOS.
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GRUB Not Showing

Boot into Ubuntu Live USB and reinstall GRUB.

Windows Boot Manager Missing

Repair Windows using the installation USB.

Secure Boot Issues

Disable Secure Boot temporarily from BIOS if Ubuntu fails to boot.

Conclusion

This guide covers:

- Windows installation
- Ubuntu installation
- Dual boot setup
- Ubuntu to Windows migration
- Windows to Ubuntu migration
- BIOS access
- Boot menu shortcuts
- Windows setup commands
- Essential keyboard shortcuts
- Common troubleshooting steps

It can be used as a reference for fresh installations, dual-boot configurations, and operating system recovery.